

◆ CHAPTER 05 • RETURN

FIRST LIGHT – the full daily protocol

DATE Sun 13 Sep 2026

HM SEP 27 • TMM JAN 17 • 70.3 FEB 17 • 100K DEC 27 • IRONMAN JAN 28

THE COVENANT – THE 5 THAT ANCHOR THE DAY

☐ WAKE before 4:30 AM☐ MEDITATION – Brahma Muhurta, 4:45☐ WORKOUT☐ JOURNAL☐ SLEEP 6.5H+ – lights out 9:45 PMThe wake is won at **lights-out**, not at the alarm – that is the one to defend. Miss it and tomorrow is already decided.

DAY MODE – PICK ONE AT WAKE. ALL THREE KEEP THE STREAK.

☐ FULL everything on this sheet☐ KEYSTONE the ★ items only – late
wake, travel, heavy load☐ ANCHOR the Covenant only – ill,
wrecked, broken sleepA smaller day is not a failed day. KEYSTONE and ANCHOR hold the streak and carry **no penance**. The only failed day is an unlogged one.

IF THE MORNING IS ALREADY LOST – DO NOT RUN THE CHAIN FROM WHERE YOU WOKE

1. Drop to **KEYSTONE**. Do not attempt the full chain – it will eat the 9:00 open.
2. Sit **3 minutes** in place of the full Brahma Muhurta block. Three minutes counts.
3. Rejoin at the next **FIXED** event below. Everything between them is compressible.

FIXED – 6:00 in the water • 9:00 market open • 7:00 PM laptop close + phone off • 9:45 PM lights out
Never push rituals into the night to “finish” the day. That buys one checkbox with tomorrow’s morning – it is how nine days get lost.

◇ RETURN RAMP – BACK FROM THE FEVER BREAK (SEP 4–12). THE RAMP COSTS STUDY TIME, NEVER RITUAL TIME.

W1	Sep 13–19	wake 4:30 AM	lights out 9:45 PM	Study 1+2 → 40 min ◀ THIS WEEK
W2	Sep 20–26	wake 4:00 AM	lights out 9:15 PM	Study 1+2 → 65 min
W3	Sep 27 onward	wake 3:30 AM	lights out 8:45 PM	Study 1+2 → full 90 min

◆ DEEP WORK – THE TWO MISSIONS



STOCK MARKET STUDY



INTERVIEW PREP & CODING

◇ 25 MORNING RULE Today's rule from the 25 Daily Rules. Read. Absorb. Apply. → # _____

◇ SPEAK ALOUD

On waking: Thanks – universe, everyone, five elements.**Morning • Ikigai:** "I am not trying to win. I am refusing to stop."**Pre-workout:** Box breathing 4-4-4-4 ×5 → go.**5:20 PM (wrap-up):** "Shutdown complete."**Morning & Night • Ho'oponopono:** "I love you. I'm sorry. Please forgive me. Thank you."**Kaizen:** "Tomorrow I improve one thing by 1%."

◇ FOOD CODE

Rice OK • no fried • no processed sugar

Chew 32× • no phone/laptop while eating

Hara Hachi Bu – eat to 80% full

Lunch = biggest meal (athlete portion) • 5 PM top-up on big days**Night = milk + paneer only** – nothing after Shata Pada – 100 steps after every meal

Warm water only w/ meals – never cold (Agni)

Protein ×4 meals – whey / paneer / dahi / sattv

Eat order: salad+dal first • roti last • millet > white rice

Tea/coffee ≥1h from meals • **last caffeine 2 PM**

Water ~3L/day • 1 anthocyanin fruit (jamun/berries/amla)

◇ ANCHORS

Sleep: lights out 9:45 PM • Fri+Sat 15 min earlier → wake 4:30 AM (6.5h = covenant floor)**Wake before 4:30 AM** – no snooze, ever**Swim 6:00 SHARP daily exc WED** • WED long run 5AM • TUE run 4:15PM • TUE/THU/FRI gym 7:30 • SAT ride 60-90' • SUN TRI (ride+brick) • market 9-3

Races: HM Sep 27 • TMM Jan 17 • 70.3 Feb 17

No sleep 4 AM – 5 PM (watch-tracked)**Brahmacharya** – Ojas conserved & raised

The wake is decided at 9:45 PM the night before – not at the alarm

★ = tier-1, non-negotiable

◇ WRITE – FILL THROUGH THE DAY

4:45 _____ one thing
 Micro-gratitude _____
 Night • _____
 3 wins _____
 Tomorrow, _____
 1% better _____

RAMP WEEK 1 – the times below are the full 3:30 chain. This week you wake at **4:30 AM**: run the oral-care and Brahma Muhurta blocks in the order printed, just 60 min later. **Study 1+2 absorbs the entire cut** – nothing else shrinks. From **5:40 (pre-train)** onward the sheet is exact: the 6:00 water and the 9:00 open do not move. **WEDNESDAY is the exception** – the long run goes at 5:00 and cannot shift, so there is NO study block: wake, minimum rituals, out the door.

- WAKE – ORAL CARE (3:30-3:45)**
- ☐ 3:30 Alarm – Wake immediately *
 - ☐ 3:30 Wake gratitude - thank the universe
 - ☐ 3:31 Tongue scraper (copper)
 - ☐ 3:32 Oil pull (coconut oil)
 - ☐ 3:33 Cold water dive reflex *
 - ☐ 3:35 Spit oil pull + rinse
 - ☐ 3:36 Brush teeth
 - ☐ 3:37 Fenugreek water (soaked overnight)
 - ☐ 3:40 Collagen 15g + amla (vit C)
 - ☐ 3:42 Pre-run hydration – 500-750ml + pinch of salt

- BRAHMA MUHURTA (3:45-4:05)**
- ☐ 3:45 Marma point self-massage
 - ☐ 3:47 Pranayama (Nadi Shodhana)
 - ☐ 3:52 Japa (108 beads)
 - ☐ 3:58 Thai forest meditation
 - ☐ 4:00 Ho'oponopono prayer (morning)
 - ☐ 4:02 Brahmacharya mala (intention set)
- STUDY 1+2 (4:05-5:45)**
- ☐ 4:05 Coffee + L-theanine – phone-free
 - ☐ 4:15 STUDY 1+2 – 90 min: INTERVIEW PREP + CODING *
- PRE-TRAIN (5:40-6:00)**
- ☐ 5:40 Oats bowl (pre-train fuel)
 - ☐ 5:45 Creatine 5g (daily – rest days too) *
 - ☐ 5:47 Hard-day fuel – 2-3 dates / 1 banana
 - ☐ 5:48 Ikigai spoken aloud
 - ☐ 5:50 2-min visualization - see the day executed *
 - ☐ 5:52 Box breathing (4-4-4-4)

- RUNS – WEEKLY MAP**
- ☐ 5:00 RUN – We LONG 5:00 AM · Tu easy 4:15 PM · Su brick *
- SWIM (6:00-6:50)**
- ☐ 6:00 SWIM – daily except Wednesday *
- POST-TRAIN (7:15-7:45)**
- ☐ 7:15 Post-workout meal FIRST (whey + carbs) + L-carnitine
 - ☐ 7:25 Hot shower (38-42°C, 10 min)
 - ☐ 7:35 Moisturiser + sunscreen
 - ☐ 7:42 Free writing
 - ☐ 7:45 Calf + soleus micro-dose – 15 min (We AM + Tu PM)
- STUDY 2 / GYM (7:30-8:50)**
- ☐ 7:50 STUDY 2 – 60 min: STOCK MARKET (Tu/Th/Fr: GYM instead) *

- MID-MORNING (8:45-9:00)**
- ☐ 8:45 Ginger lime shot
 - ☐ 8:46 Chyawanprash (1 tsp)
 - ☐ 8:48 Shata Pada (100 steps after meal)
 - ☐ 8:50 Sunlight exposure (5 min) *
 - ☐ 8:52 Vitamins (D3+K2, algal Omega-3 ≥1g, B12) *
 - ☐ 8:53 Fruit break – jamun / pomegranate / berries
 - ☐ 8:54 Review time blocks for the day
- MARKET (9:00-3:00)**
- ☐ 9:00 MARKET OPEN – at the desk 9:00-3:00 *
- DESK PREP (8:45-9:00)**
- ☐ 8:45 Lunch dabba ready – desk lunch at 1:30
 - ☐ 8:50 Desk ready – market prep (office days: leave ~8:20)

o MIDDAY

17 items

- PRE-LUNCH RESET (12:00-1:25)**
- ☐ 12:00 Posture reset + desk ergonomics
 - ☐ 12:05 20-20-20 eye rule
 - ☐ 12:10 Hydration check (750ml by noon)
 - ☐ 1:00 Standing stretch (5 min)
 - ☐ 1:10 Box breathing (2 min)

- LUNCH WINDOW (1:30-2:00)**
- ☐ 1:30 Lunch – salad+dal FIRST, paneer/dahi, roti LAST *
 - ☐ 1:50 Shata Pada (100 steps after lunch)
 - ☐ 1:55 Warm water (copper vessel)
- POST-MARKET (3:05-5:30)**
- ☐ 3:05 STUDY 3 – 40 min: MARKET REVIEW / flex (Tue: run 4:15 after) *

- AFTERNOON FUEL (3:30-4:00)**
- ☐ 3:30 DECAF green tea + L-Theanine
 - ☐ 3:35 Handful of soaked almonds/walnuts
 - ☐ 3:40 Afternoon sunlight (5 min)
 - ☐ 3:45 Micro-gratitude (1 thing)

- WRAP UP (5:00-5:30)**
- ☐ 5:00 End-of-work task review
 - ☐ 5:10 Inbox zero pass
 - ☐ 5:20 Shutdown ritual – "Shutdown complete"
- FUEL TOP-UP (5:00-5:30)**
- ☐ 5:00 5 PM top-up – sattu shake / fruit + PB + 2 kiwis *

☾ EVENING

31 items

- EVENING – 7 PM SHUTDOWN**
- ☐ 7:00 Laptop close – HARD STOP *
 - ☐ 7:01 PHONE OFF → hall drawer (lives in the HALL, travels nowhere; ON 9:00) *
 - ☐ 7:02 Internet OFF
 - ☐ 7:10 Shata Pada (100 steps)

- NIGHT PREP (7:12-7:22)**
- ☐ 7:12 Tomorrow planning (time blocks)
 - ☐ 7:14 Fill copper vessel + soak methi + oats
 - ☐ 7:15 Kit packed – tomorrow's sport
 - ☐ 7:16 Clothes laid out (run + gym kit)
 - ☐ 7:17 Supplements laid out
 - ☐ 7:18 Keys + essentials ready
 - ☐ 7:19 Hot water ready (thermos)
 - ☐ 7:20 Loban (frankincense) lit

- SKIN + OIL RITUALS (7:25-7:48)**
- ☐ 7:32 Coconut oil (face + body)
 - ☐ 7:35 Nasya oil (2 drops per nostril)
 - ☐ 7:40 Mula Bandha practice
 - ☐ 7:42 Abhyanga (self oil massage)
 - ☐ 7:45 Shilajit (ICP-MS COA-verified ONLY)
 - ☐ 7:47 Olive oil on navel
- WIND DOWN + SLEEP (7:50-8:05)**
- ☐ 7:50 Magnesium glycinate + Glycine + Triphala (cycled) *
 - ☐ 7:52 Milk + paneer + Ashwagandha – night closed

- DAY CLOSE (8:05)**
- ☐ 8:05 Night prep confirmed ✓
 - ☐ 8:06 All electronics on charge - OUTSIDE bedroom
- REFLECTION + SLEEP (8:05-8:45)**
- ☐ 8:05 Roman Examen (review of conscience)
 - ☐ 8:08 3 Wins of the day
 - ☐ 8:12 Reverse day replay (end to start)
 - ☐ 8:15 Gratitude (3 things)
 - ☐ 8:18 Trataka (candle gazing)
 - ☐ 8:22 Ho'oponopono prayer
 - ☐ 8:25 Cyclic sighing (5 min) *
 - ☐ 8:40 Evening oral care - brush + interdental
 - ☐ 8:45 LIGHTS OUT *

♦ WEEKEND

Sat + Sun only

- SATURDAY**
- ☐ SAT Laundry – wash + dry
 - ☐ SAT Sun-tri prep – bottles + bike in car · lights out 8:30
 - ☐ SAT Hammam scrub – kessa mitt full body
 - ☐ SAT Brahmi/Bhringraj hair oiling – overnight
 - ☐ SAT Kesar + raw milk face mask – 15 min
 - ☐ SAT Car interior clean

- SUNDAY**
- ☐ SUN Abhyanga full body self-massage – 10-15 min
 - ☐ SUN Temple visit
 - ☐ SUN Park or nature sit – 1h min (Shinrin-yoku)
 - ☐ SUN Friluftsliv – 20-30 min purposeless walk
 - ☐ SUN Kesar + raw milk face mask
 - ☐ SUN Brahmi/bhringraj hair oiling
 - ☐ SUN PERMA weekly audit – P E R M A each 1-10
 - ☐ SUN Grocery + weekly prep + soak methi (+ jamun/kiwi/millet/sattu)
 - ☐ SUN Full room reset + clothes fold
 - ☐ SUN Rest – minimal tasks only

1	Wake before sunrise	6	Meditation (Vipassana)	11	Ashwagandha	16	Sleep – before 10 PM	21	Qigong / Tai Chi
2	Tongue scraping (copper)	7	Zone-2 cardio	12	Green tea (matcha)	17	Nasya (nasal oil)	22	Earthing / grounding
3	Oil pulling (Gandusha)	8	Sunlight – first 30 min	13	Turmeric + black pepper	18	Strength training 3x/wk	23	Amla (daily)
4	Cold water exposure	9	Hara Hachi Bu (eat to 80%)	14	Intermittent fasting (16:8)	19	Forest bathing (weekly)	24	Japa / mantra
5	Pranayama (Nadi Shodhana)	10	Triphala before bed	15	Abhyanga (oil massage)	20	Ekadashi fast (2x/mo)	25	Ikigai – purpose

◇ KEY PRACTICES – how to do them

Box breathing: in 4 · hold 4 · out 4 · hold 4 – x5 rounds	Nadi Shodhana: alternate-nostril, equal in/out – 5 min	Trataka: steady gaze on candle flame, no blink – 5 min	Mula Bandha: root lock – engage 10s, release – 10 reps	Abhyanga: warm oil, toward the heart, 10–15 min
Cyclic sighing: 2 short nose inhales → 1 long mouth exhale – 5 min	Kapalabhati: sharp exhales, passive inhale – 30–50	Marma: Ajna · Hridaya · Nabhi – 30s each, clockwise	Shata Pada: 100 gentle steps after every meal	Cold dive reflex: face in cold water – resets the vagus nerve

◆ SEASON PLAN 2026-27

HM Sep 27 · TMM (A-RACE) Jan 17 · 70.3 Feb 17

Week: MON swim-easy (recovery) · TUE swim+gym AM, easy run 4:15PM · WED LONG RUN 5-7AM · THU swim+gym · FRI swim+gym(light), rest 8:30 · SAT swim + ride 60-90' · SUN TRI: swim-long ride-brick 5-10k (full 15-21k brick 1x/mo) · Nov+: long run swaps to SUNDAY	Ride glide path: Aug-Oct 100k · Nov 100/70 · Dec ≤60k easy · Jan ≤40k · Feb 90k race-sims. Long run is the currency – never sacrificed to the bike To HM (Sep 27): long runs 12-14-16+10 · race @ HR≤160, 6:10-6:15/km thru 15k · A sub-2:05 · B 2:10 (May bench: 2:09 @HR171)	To TMM (Jan 17): Oct 14-18k · Nov 20-24k · Dec 26-32k peak · 3-wk taper · target 4:20-4:35 – lock after HM To 70.3 (Feb 17): 2wk recover · swim+2.2k + open-water x2-3 · 90k sims + bricks · ~6:30-7:00	Laws: easy = HR≤145 · <6h sleep or RHR +7 → 2nd session cancelled · Sat = highest-carb day · monsoon: Fri radar decides · bone/tendon pain → pre-decided fallback (HM-10k) Fuel: never long fasted · 30-60g carbs/h >90min · Sun = gut-training rehearsal · Fri eve: bike in car + bottles mixed · office exit 6:45 sharp	Paces (yours): EASY 7:00-7:30/km HR≤145 – feels too slow = correct · LONG = easy pace + km dial, cap 150, walk 60s/5k · MP 6:10-6:20 · HM-eff 5:55-6:10 · strides 4x20s · HR beats pace beats feel Horizon: → 100 KM RUN Dec 2027 · → FULL IRONMAN Jan 2028 – same template forever, monthly dials in the Master Plan doc
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LOG THE DAY 6:40–6:55 PM · PHONE OFF 7:00 → ON 9:00 · One clock, every day.

◇ HOURLY RESET • WORK FROM HOME

55 minutes of work • 5 minutes of reset • the day is built one block at a time

DATE Sun 13 Sep 2026

THE RESET – ON YOUR FEET, NO SCREEN, NO PHONE, FINISHED BEFORE YOU SIT BACK DOWN

10

ANULOM VILOM

left in • right out • right in • left out = 1 round • ~3 min

10

PUSH-UPS

full range, chest to the floor, no rushing the last three

10

SQUATS

bodyweight, heels down, hips to below the knee

1

GLASS WATER

250 ml, drunk standing – not carried back to the desk

◇ THE CHAIN – ONE BOX PER COMPLETED BLOCK. AN HOUR WITHOUT THE RESET DOES NOT FILL A BOX.

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

START	BLOCK	THE ONE THING – WRITTEN BEFORE YOU START	BRTH	PUSH	SQT	H2O	FOCUS	DISTRACTIONS
1 5:05	STUDY 40min		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
2 7:50	STUDY 2 / GYM		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
3 9:00	MARKET		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
4 10:00	MARKET		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
5 11:00	MARKET		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
6 12:00	MARKET		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
7 2:00	MARKET		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
8 3:05	STUDY 3		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	
9 4:05	FLEX		☐	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5	

◇ DAY GAUGE – FILL AT 6:40 PM WITH THE LOG

BLOCKS _____ /9 PUSH-UPS _____ SQUATS _____ WATER _____ glasses • _____ L BREATH ROUNDS _____

AVG FOCUS _____ /5 DISTRACTIONS _____ LONGEST CHAIN _____

A full 9 blocks = 90 push-ups • 90 squats • 90 rounds of breath • 2.25 L water – before a single training session. That is the compounding: none of it was a workout, all of it was a day. • Training-day trim: TUE (lower-body gym) → squats to 5 • THU (upper + core) → push-ups to 5 • WED (long run) → both to 5.

◇ RULES OF THE BLOCK

Name it first. Write the ONE thing before the timer starts. If you cannot name it, you are not ready to start – that is a planning problem, not a focus problem.

Phone in the hall drawer. Not face-down, not in the room. Territory rule, same as 7 PM.

Tally, don't chase. Every time attention breaks, make one mark. Counting it is what kills it – the mark is the whole intervention.

Park it. A thought that isn't the ONE thing goes in the list → straight back to work. It will still be there at 6:40.

The reset is not a break. It is the thing that makes block 6 as sharp as block 1. Skipping it to “keep going” is how the afternoon dies.

Never two in a row missed. One skipped reset is a slip. Two is a new habit.

◇ PARK IT – THE THOUGHT GOES HERE, YOU GO BACK TO WORK

THE CHAIN IS THE POINT • 55 ON • 5 OFF • Ten small resets beat one heroic hour.